

Letterboxd

Data Collection and Curation

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Motivation

Why is this project exciting?

- Letterboxd is a growing social platform with millions of passionate film users.
- Movie data like reviews, ratings, and tags are a personal and subjective, making it complex and interesting to study.
- Curating this data well supports better film trend analysis.

Why does it matter?

- Poor data affects user experience.

Overview

What's the focus?

- Understand how Letterboxd collects, organizes, and manages user-generated content.
- Explore challenges like duplicate movies and subjective tagging.

Project Category

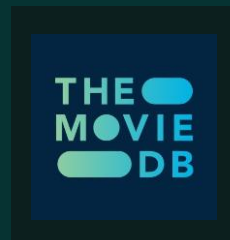
- Data collection and curation.

Related Work and Tools



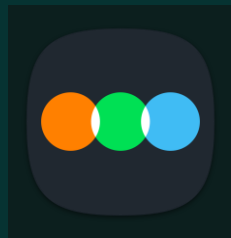
MovieLens

Research dataset



TMDb

Film data



Letterboxd API

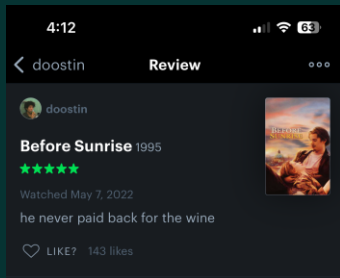
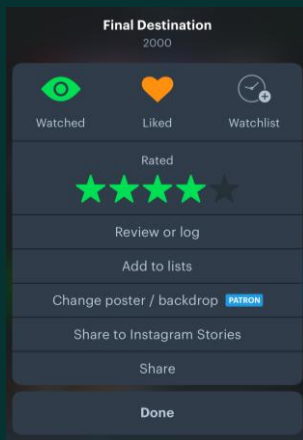
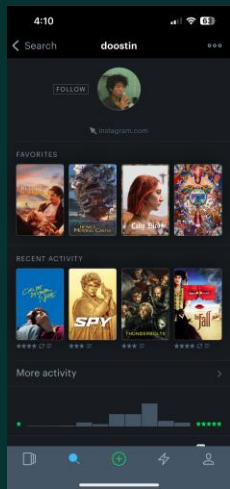
Data structure access



**Collaborative
Filtering**

Used by third-party tools
that rely on Letterboxd
data.

Data Types Collected



- Ratings (1–5 stars)
- Reviews (written)
- Watchlists & likes
- Tags (user-created labels for genre, tone, mood, etc.)

Technical Components

How is the data collected?

- Through user interaction on the platform
- Available via API (structured in JSON)

How is it structured?

- Movie metadata, user activity logs, tag databases



Challenges in Data Curation



Duplicate films



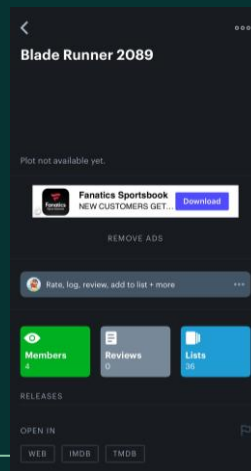
**Subjective or
inconsistent tags**



**Incomplete or
sparse data for
films**



Example:



Data Science Lifecycle Connection

Data acquisition: User inputs + API access

Data preparation: Deduplication, tag filtering, cleaning

Modeling: Letterboxd doesn't offer its own recommendation system, but its data is used by others for modeling

Evaluation: Third-party tools evaluate success based on performance or feedback

Data Science Lifecycle Connection

Deployment: Occurs outside Letterboxd. Used in recommendation apps, research projects

Operations: Letterboxd maintains APIs and data access infrastructure

Optimization: Often handled by external developers refining their tools using Letterboxd data

Hypothetical Team Roles

I.

DATA ENGINEER

- Build and maintain pipelines
- Clean raw user data

II.

DATA ANALYST

- Identify trends in reviews, ratings, watchlists

Impacts & Outcomes

FOR USERS

External tools can offer recommendations, smarter discovery features

FOR DEVELOPERS

Access to structured, curated data to build custom movie-related applications

FOR RESEARCHERS

Opportunities to study movie tastes, genre trends, and user behavior

Ethical Considerations

- Respect for user privacy (even with public data)
- Bias in tagging and reviewing
- Transparency in how public data is scraped or reused in third-party tools

REFERENCES

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- <https://grouplens.org/datasets/movielens/>
- <https://www.engadget.com/letterboxd-sells-a-majority-stake-after-explosive-pandemic-fueled-growth-201646444.html>
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